Commons: set-up guide

See what your company uses Claude Cowork and Claude Code for, which skills and connectors people run, and which recurring jobs need a skill. It is a Claude plugin plus a dashboard. A Claude **Owner** sets it up once; employees install nothing.

	A. Hosted (we run the server)	B. Self-hosted (you run it)
Your data is stored in	Our database (see "What we store" below)	Only your own database
Time to set up	About 10 minutes	About 45 minutes
You need	A Claude Team or Enterprise Owner	That, plus GitHub, Vercel, Postgres (Neon) and a Sarvam API key

A Hosted

You receive: an **organization ID**, a **dashboard password** (sent separately) and an **org token** (`cmn_…`). The token can only send data to your organization; it can't read anything.

1. **Sign in** at `commons-adoption.vercel.app/login`. Change your password under Settings.
2. **Download your plugin:** go to **Settings**, paste the org token, then click **Download plugin (.zip)**. Keep the file inside your company.
3. **Allow the domain:** in Claude, go to **Organization settings › Capabilities** and add `commons-adoption.vercel.app` to the allowed domains. Cowork blocks sites that aren't on this list.
4. **Add the plugin:** go to **Organization settings › Plugins › Add › Upload plugin**, choose the .zip, then set its default access to **Required**.
5. **Monitoring (optional), to see names, tokens and cost:** go to **Admin settings › Cowork › Monitoring** and enter: Endpoint `https://commons-adoption.vercel.app` · Protocol `http/json` · Headers `Authorization=Bearer <org token>`. Skip this step and Commons stays anonymous.
6. **Test:** reopen the Claude app, start a **new** Cowork task, do one real task, then run `/commons:my-usage`. Events show on **Live events** within a minute, and on **Analytics** about 2 minutes later.

What we store (hosted)

Data	Kept
Text of each prompt sent to Claude, used only to label the kind of work	**30 days**, then deleted
Session labels: category, task and a one-line summary	While you use Commons
Names of the skills, connectors and tools used	While you use Commons
File type of created files (e.g. `.docx`), not the name or contents	While you use Commons
Session ID and timestamps	While you use Commons
Only with monitoring on: email, model, tokens, estimated cost	While you use Commons
Skills shared with `/commons:share-skill`	Until an admin removes them

Never stored: Claude's replies, file contents, file names and paths, tool outputs, folder paths. If monitoring sends these, the server drops them on arrival.

Processors: Vercel (server, Singapore), Neon (database, Singapore), Sarvam AI (India, labels prompts). Only your admins see your dashboard. To delete all of your data, ask us; deleting your organization removes everything linked to it.

B Self-hosted

1. **Fork** `github.com/Prince-sharma/commons` and keep the fork public.
2. **Create a Vercel project** from the fork with **Root Directory** `server`.
3. **Add a database:** Storage › Neon › Create. This sets `DATABASE_URL`.
4. **Set environment variables:** `SESSION_SECRET`, `CRON_SECRET` (random strings), `SUPERADMIN_PASSWORD`, `SARVAM_API_KEY`, `COMMONS_PLUGIN_REPO=<you>/commons`. If your Sarvam key has no beta access, also set `SARVAM_MODEL=sarvam-105b` and `SARVAM_BASE_URL=https://api.sarvam.ai/v1`.
5. **Deploy.** Tables are created automatically. Check that `/api/health` returns OK.
6. **Create your organization** at `/setup` using `SUPERADMIN_PASSWORD`, and save the ID, password and token (they're shown once).
7. **Do steps 1–6 of A** with your own address in place of `commons-adoption.vercel.app`.

Let Claude do it: paste into Claude Code (with git, gh and vercel signed in)

```
Set up a self-hosted Commons server for our company from
https://github.com/Prince-sharma/commons. Read the README
("Option 2: self-host") and docs/SETUP.md (section B) first,
then:
1. Fork the repo to our GitHub account with gh (keep it
public) and clone it.
2. Ask me which region we want. Set "regions" in
server/vercel.json to the matching Vercel region, then
commit and push.
3. Create a Vercel project from the fork with Root Directory
"server" and link it.
4. Add a Neon Postgres database via the Vercel Marketplace
in the same region and connect it, so DATABASE_URL is set.
5. Set Production env vars: SESSION_SECRET and CRON_SECRET
(generate long random strings), SUPERADMIN_PASSWORD
(generate a strong one), SARVAM_API_KEY (ask me),
COMMONS_PLUGIN_REPO=<our-github>/commons. Ask whether our
Sarvam key has beta access. If not, also set
SARVAM_MODEL=sarvam-105b and
SARVAM_BASE_URL=https://api.sarvam.ai/v1. Never print
secrets in the chat. Save them to a local file only I can
read, and tell me where it is.
6. Deploy to production and check that /api/health returns
OK.
7. Give me the server address and next steps: sign in at
/setup, create our organization, then follow docs/SETUP.md
section A, using our address.
Ask me before anything that costs money or needs approval in
a browser.
```

If something doesn't work

No plugin events, or `my-usage` fails with "403"	The domain isn't allowed (A3), or the plugin isn't Required. Start a **new** task.
Monitoring on, but "matched to a person" stays at 0	Analytics still works without names. Send us a screenshot.
Sessions never get a category	Wait 2 minutes. If self-hosted, check the Sarvam key.

Full guide: `docs/SETUP.md` in github.com/Prince-sharma/commons · Privacy note: `PRIVACY.md` · Commons is open source (MIT).